# Partial Differential Equations

PENG

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# 1 Introduction

## 1.1 Notation

**Definition 1.1** ($n$-dimensional real Euclidean space)**.** $\mathbb{R}^n$

**Definition 1.2** (point in $\mathbb{R}^n$)**.**

$$x := \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{bmatrix} \tag{1.1}$$

**Definition 1.3** ($u(x)$)**.**

$$u : U \to \mathbb{R} \Leftrightarrow u(x) := u(x_1, \ldots, x_n) \quad (x \in U) \tag{1.2}$$

**Definition 1.4** (standard coordinate vector)**.**

$$e_i := \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \tag{1.3}$$

**Definition 1.5** (derivative)**.**

$$u_{x_i} := \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_i}(x) = \lim_{h \to 0} \frac{u(x + he_i) - u(x)}{h} \tag{1.4}$$

**Definition 1.6** (smooth)**.** *$u$ is smooth provided $u$ is* ***infinitely differentiable****.*

**Definition 1.7** (multi-index of order)**.**

$$\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} \alpha_1 \\ \vdots \\ \alpha_n \end{bmatrix} \tag{1.5}$$

$$|\alpha| = \alpha_1 + \ldots + \alpha_n \tag{1.6}$$

*where* $\alpha_i \geq 0$

**Definition 1.8** ($D^\alpha$)**.**

$$D^\alpha u(x) := \frac{\partial^{|\alpha|} u(x)}{\partial x_1^{\alpha_1} \ldots \partial x_n^{\alpha_n}} = \partial_{x_1}^{\alpha_1} \ldots \partial_{x_n}^{\alpha_n} u \tag{1.7}$$

**Definition 1.9** ($D^k$)**.**

$$D^k u(x) := \{D^\alpha u(x) : |\alpha| = k\} \tag{1.8}$$

**Definition 1.10** (gradient vector)**.**

$$Du = \nabla u := \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_1} \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_n} \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^n \tag{1.9}$$

**Definition 1.11** (Hessian matrix)**.** *Real symmetrical matrices:*

$$D^2 u := \begin{bmatrix} u_{x_1 x_1} & \ldots & u_{x_1 x_n} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ u_{x_n x_1} & \ldots & u_{x_n x_n} \end{bmatrix} \tag{1.10}$$

**Definition 1.12** ($A : B$)**.**

$$A : B = \sum_{i=1}^{m} \sum_{j=1}^{n} a_{ij} b_{ij} \tag{1.11}$$

**Definition 1.13** ($|A|$)**.**

$$|A| = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^{m} \sum_{j=1}^{n} a_{ij}^2} \tag{1.12}$$

**Definition 1.14** (vector dot product and matrix multiplication)**.**

$$A \cdot B = A^T B = [a_1 \ldots a_n] \begin{bmatrix} b_1 \\ \vdots \\ b_n \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i b_i \tag{1.13}$$

**Definition 1.15** (radial derivative)**.**

$$\begin{aligned} u_r :=& \frac{x}{|x|} \cdot Du = \frac{1}{|x|} [x_1 \ldots x_n] \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_1} \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_n} \end{bmatrix} \\ =& \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_i}}{\sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^2}} \quad (x \neq 0) \end{aligned} \tag{1.14}$$

**Definition 1.16** ($\boldsymbol{u}$)**.**

$$\boldsymbol{u} : U \to \mathbb{R}^m \Leftrightarrow \boldsymbol{u} := \begin{bmatrix} u^1 \\ \vdots \\ u^m \end{bmatrix} \tag{1.15}$$

**Definition 1.17** ($D^\alpha \boldsymbol{u}$)**.**

$$D^\alpha \boldsymbol{u} := \begin{bmatrix} D^\alpha u^1 \\ \vdots \\ D^\alpha u^n \end{bmatrix} \tag{1.16}$$

**Definition 1.18** ($D^k \boldsymbol{u}$)**.**

$$D^k \boldsymbol{u} := \{D^\alpha \boldsymbol{u} : |\alpha| = k\} \tag{1.17}$$

**Definition 1.19** (gradient matrix)**.**

$$D\boldsymbol{u} := \begin{bmatrix} u^1_{x_1} & \dots & u^1_{x_n} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ u^m_{x_1} & \dots & u^m_{x_n} \end{bmatrix} \tag{1.18}$$

## 1.2 PDE

**Definition 1.20** ($\mathrm{k}^{\mathrm{th}}$-order PDE)**.**

$$F(D^k u(x), D^{k-1} u(x), \dots, Du(x), u(x), x) = 0 \tag{1.19}$$

*where* $x \in U$, $u : U \to \mathbb{R}$, *and* $F : \mathbb{R}^{n^k} \times \mathbb{R}^{n^{k-1}} \times \cdots \times \mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R} \times U \to \mathbb{R}$

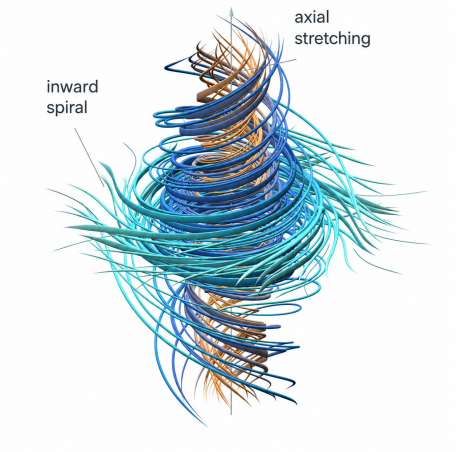



Figure 1.1: FINITE TIME BLOWUP FOR NAVIER-STOKES [2].

**Definition 1.21** (linear PDE)**.**

$$\sum_{|\alpha| \le k} a_\alpha(x) D^\alpha u = f(x) \tag{1.20}$$

$f \equiv 0 \Rightarrow$ *homogeneous*

**Definition 1.22** (semi-linear)**.**

$$\sum_{|\alpha| = k} a_\alpha(x) D^\alpha u + a_0(D^{k-1} u, \dots, Du, u, x) = 0 \tag{1.21}$$

**Definition 1.23** (quasi-linear)**.**

$$\sum_{|\alpha| = k} a_\alpha(D^{k-1} u, \dots, Du, u, x) D^\alpha u + a_0(D^{k-1} u, \dots, Du, u, x) = 0 \tag{1.22}$$

**Remark 1.24** (nonlinear)**.** *Full non-linearity depends on the highest order derivatives.*

**Definition 1.25** ($\mathrm{k}^{\mathrm{th}}$-order system of PDE)**.**

$$F(D^k \boldsymbol{u}(x), D^{k-1} \boldsymbol{u}(x), \dots, D\boldsymbol{u}(x), \boldsymbol{u}(x), x) = 0 \tag{1.23}$$

*where* $x \in U$, $\boldsymbol{u} : U \to \mathbb{R}^m$, *and* $F : \mathbb{R}^{mn^k} \times \mathbb{R}^{mn^{k-1}} \times \cdots \times \mathbb{R}^{mn} \times \mathbb{R}^m \times U \to \mathbb{R}^m$

### 1.3 Solutions to PDE

**Definition 1.26** (solutions to PDE [1])**.**

- *classic solutions*
  - *explicit, closed-form formula: polynomials, exp, cos, sin*
  - *or at least show such a solution exists, and to deduce various of its properties*
- *weak solutions and regularity (smoothness)*

**Remark 1.27.** *Existence is the prime attribute of what we study.*

## 2 Four Fundamental Linear PDE

**Definition 2.1** (Fundamental linear PDE)**.**

- *Transport equation*
- *Laplace's equation*
- *Heat equation*
- *Wave equation*

**Lemma 2.2.** $\frac{dy}{d(x+b)} = \frac{dy}{dx}$

*Proof.*

$$\frac{dy}{d(x+b)} = \frac{\frac{dy}{dx}}{\frac{d(x+b)}{dx}} = \frac{dy}{dx}$$

□

### 2.1 Transport Equation

**Definition 2.3** (Transport equation)**.**

$$u_t + b \cdot Du = \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + [b_1 b_2 \dots b_n] \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_1} \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_2} \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_n} \end{bmatrix} = \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + \sum_{i=n}^{n} b_i \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_i} = 0 \tag{2.1}$$

**Example 2.4.** *For 1D and 2D cases:*

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + b\frac{\partial u}{\partial x} = 0$$
$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + b_1\frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + b_2\frac{\partial u}{\partial y} = 0$$

**Theorem 2.5.** *For Eq. 2.1, $u$ is constant on the line $(x,t) + (b,1)s$ for $s \in \mathbb{R}$.*

*Proof.* Let $z(s) := u(x + bs, t + s)$.

$$\frac{dz}{ds} = \frac{\partial u}{\partial(t+s)}\frac{d(t+s)}{ds} + \frac{\partial u}{\partial(x+sb)}\frac{d(x+sb)}{ds} = \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + b\frac{\partial u}{\partial x} \overset{\text{Eq. 2.1}}{=} 0$$
$$z(s) = u(x + sb, t + s) = C$$

□

**Proposition 2.6** (initial-value problem)**.**

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + b\frac{\partial u}{\partial x} = 0 \\ u(x,0) = g(x) \end{cases}$$

$$u(x,t) \overset{\textit{Theo. 2.5}}{=} u(x - tb, 0) = g(x - tb)$$

**Proposition 2.7** (nonhomogenous problem)**.**

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + b \cdot \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} = f(x,t) \\ u(x,0) = g(x) \end{cases}$$

*Let* $z(s) := u(x+sb, t+s)$.

$$\frac{dz}{ds} = f(x+sb, t+s)$$

$$z(s) = u(x+sb, t+s) = \int f(x+sb, t+s)ds$$

$$z(0) - z(-t) = u(x,t) - u(x-tb, 0) = u(x,t) - g(x-tb) = \int_{-t}^{0} f(x+sb, t+s)ds$$

$$u(x,t) = g(x-tb) + \int_{-t}^{0} f(x+sb, t+s)ds$$

## 2.2 Laplace's Equation

**Definition 2.8** (Laplace's equation)**.**

$$\Delta u = \nabla \cdot \nabla u = \nabla^2 u = \left[\frac{\partial}{\partial x_1} \frac{\partial}{\partial x_2} \cdots \frac{\partial}{\partial x_n}\right] \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_1} \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_2} \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_n} \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x_i^2} = 0 \tag{2.2}$$

**Example 2.9.** *For 1D and 2D cases:*

$$\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} = 0$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial y^2} = 0$$

**Definition 2.10** (outward derivative)**.**

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial v} := \boldsymbol{v} \cdot Du = [v_1 v_2 \dots v_n] \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_1} \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_2} \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_n} \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} v_i \frac{\partial u}{\partial x_i}$$

*where* $\boldsymbol{v}$ *is the unit outer normal vector of* $\partial U$.

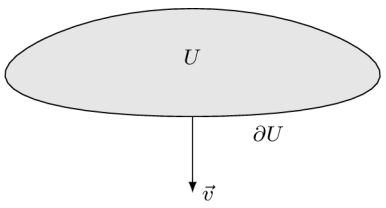



Figure 2.1: Outward derivative.

**Example 2.11.** *For 1D and 2D cases:*

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial v} = v \frac{\partial u}{\partial x}$$

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial v} = v_1 \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + v_2 \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}$$

**Theorem 2.12** (Gauss-Green theorem)**.**

$$\begin{aligned}\int_U \nabla \cdot \boldsymbol{u} dx &= \int_U \begin{bmatrix}\frac{\partial}{\partial x_1}\frac{\partial}{\partial x_2}\cdots\frac{\partial}{\partial x_n}\end{bmatrix}\begin{bmatrix}u_1\\u_2\\\vdots\\u_n\end{bmatrix} dx = \int_U \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\partial u_i}{\partial x_i} dx \\ &= \int_{\partial U} \boldsymbol{u}\cdot\boldsymbol{v} dS = \int_{\partial U} [u_1 u_2 \dots u_3]\begin{bmatrix}v_1\\v_2\\\vdots\\v_n\end{bmatrix} dS = \int_{\partial U}\sum_{i=1}^n u_i v_i dS\end{aligned} \tag{2.3}$$

**Example 2.13.** *For 1D and 2D cases:*

$$\int_U \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} dx = \int_{\partial U} uv dS$$
$$\int_U \frac{\partial u_1}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial u_2}{\partial y} dx = \int_{\partial U} u_1 v_1 + u_2 v_2 dS$$

Fundamental solution:

$$u(x) = v(r)$$
$$r = |x| = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^n x_i^2}$$
$$\frac{\partial r}{\partial x_i} = \frac{x_i}{r}$$
$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial x_i} = \frac{dv}{dr}\frac{x_i}{r}$$
$$\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x_i^2} = \frac{d^2 v}{dr^2}\frac{x_i^2}{r^2} + \frac{dv}{dr}\frac{r^2 - x_i^2}{r^3}$$
$$\Delta u = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x_i^2} = \frac{d^2 v}{dr^2} + \frac{dv}{dr}\frac{n-1}{r} = 0$$

For $n = 1$:

$$\frac{d^2 v}{dr^2} = 0$$

$$v(r) = r + C$$

For $n \geq 2$:

$$\frac{d^2 v}{dr^2} + \frac{dv}{dr}\frac{n-1}{r} = 0$$

$$\frac{v''(r)}{v'(r)} = \ln\left(|v'(r)|\right)' = \frac{1-n}{r}$$

$$\ln\left(|v'(r)|\right) = (1-n)\ln(r) + \ln(C) = \ln\left(\frac{C}{r^{n-1}}\right)$$

$$|v'(r)| = \frac{C}{r^{n-1}}$$

$$v'(r) = \frac{C}{r^{n-1}}$$

For $n = 2$:

$$v'(r) = \frac{C}{r}$$

$$v(r) = C_1 \ln(r) + C_2$$

For $n \geq 3$:

$$v(r) = \frac{C_1}{2-n} \frac{1}{r^{n-2}} + C_2 = \frac{C_1}{r^{n-2}} + C_2$$

**Definition 2.14** (fundamental solution of Laplace's equation)**.**

$$\Phi(|x|) := \begin{cases} -\frac{1}{2\pi} \ln |x| & (n=2) \\ \frac{1}{n(n-2)\alpha(n)} \frac{1}{|x|^{n-2}} & (n \geq 3) \end{cases} \tag{2.4}$$

**Definition 2.15** (Poisson's equation)**.**

$$-\Delta u = -\sum_{i=1}^{n} \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x_i^2} = f \tag{2.5}$$

**Theorem 2.16.** *Solution of Poisson's equation:*

$$u(x) = \int_{y \in \mathbb{R}^n} \Phi(|x-y|) f(y) dy = \begin{cases} -\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \ln(|x-y|) f(y) dy & (n=2) \\ \frac{1}{n(n-2)\alpha(n)} \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \frac{f(y)}{|x-y|^{n-2}} dy & (n \geq 3) \end{cases} \tag{2.6}$$

# 3 Numerical

# 4 Asymptotic

# 5 Analytical

# References


[1] Lawrence C Evans. *Partial differential equations*. Vol. 19. American mathematical society, 2022. ISBN: 1470469421.

[2] OPENAI. *FINITE TIME BLOWUP FOR NAVIER-STOKES*. Manuscript. 2026.